# Lucas Little

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## Summary

Software engineering leader with deep expertise in AWS cloud solutions, infrastructure automation, and team leadership. Proven track record of driving cost savings, optimizing cloud architectures, and improving operational efficiencies. Skilled in modernizing financial data processes, implementing Infrastructure as Code (IaC), and leading large-scale cloud migrations to enhance scalability, security, and compliance. Adept at fostering cross-functional collaboration and aligning technology strategies with business objectives.

## Experience

**Ally Financial** **Charlotte, NC**

*Software Engineering Manager, Ally Invest* *Dec 2020 – Present*

- Led a team of 8 direct reports and oversaw 10+ indirect reports, aligning strategies with business goals and fostering collaboration.
- Modernized broker-dealer data processes, improving CAT and 606(a) reporting accuracy and enhancing data integrity.
- Achieved 100% Infrastructure as Code (IaC) coverage, migrating 30+ applications to Terraform, ensuring 95% enterprise compliance.
- Reduced operational costs by 40%, migrating 200+ batch ETL jobs to AWS and eliminating 16+ hours/month of manual patching.
- Decreased Kafka-related expenses by 60%, reducing EC2 maintenance overhead by $5K/month through refactoring.
- Cut $100K in annual costs by decommissioning Redshift, increasing system availability with zero monthly downtime.
- Saved $30K annually by streamlining data validation, eliminating redundant tooling.
- Lowered licensing costs by $20K/year, centralizing scheduling systems to improve operational efficiency.

**Ally Financial** **Charlotte, NC**

*Senior Software Engineer, Enterprise Technology Operations* *Mar 2019 – Dec 2019*

- Facilitated AWS cloud adoption across 7+ business lines, establishing a streamlined cloud project intake pipeline.
- Improved deployment efficiency by 40% by standardizing Terraform modules, reducing infrastructure provisioning time by 50%.
- Enhanced security monitoring by architecting a centralized log management system with Splunk, increasing log availability by 20% for 50+ teams.

**Ally Financial** **Charlotte, NC**

*Senior Software Engineer, Ally Invest* *Mar 2019 – Dec 2019*

- Reduced OLTP database load by 60% by implementing a real-time analytics platform with Qlik CDC and Amazon MSK, establishing a standardized AWS-based application framework.
- Ensured 100% regulatory compliance for intra-firm money movement validation by leveraging Airflow, Python, and Redshift.

**The Vanguard Group** **Charlotte, NC**

*Senior Software Engineer, Chief Technology Office* *Jan 2019 – Mar 2019*

- Achieved $2M in annual savings by optimizing EMR costs through Service Catalog-based strategies.

**Vanguard** **Charlotte, NC**

*Software Engineer, Chief Technology Office* *Jun 2017 – Jan 2019*

- Migrated 1.5 petabytes of data to AWS S3, enhancing data management efficiency and scalability.
- Saved 40 hours per month by automating redundant tasks, increasing operational efficiency.
- Facilitated enterprise-wide EMR adoption by developing reference architectures and custom plugins, streamlining deployment and usage.

**Vanguard** **Charlotte, NC**

*Software Engineer, Enterprise Shared Services* *May 2016 – Jun 2017*

- Expanded Hadoop capacity by 40%, enabling scalability for new data-driven projects.
- Accelerated AWS EMR adoption by migrating IBM Tealeaf web analytics data to the cloud, enhancing accessibility and performance.

**Bake Crew** **Concord, NC**

*Managing Member* *Nov 2009 – May 2016*

- Co-founded a consulting firm, implementing automation systems to enhance efficiency for global commercial bakeries.
- Built and maintained relationships with 10+ international clients, driving long-term business growth.

## Education

**University of Colorado - Boulder** **Boulder, Colorado**
*Masters in Computer Science* *2026*

**University of North Carolina at Charlotte** **Charlotte, NC**
*Bachelor of Science in Business Administration* *2009*

## Certifications

**AWS Advanced Networking - Specialty**: Amazon Web Services, 2021

**AWS Data Analytics - Specialty**: Amazon Web Services, 2021

**AWS Certified Database - Specialty**: Amazon Web Services, 2019

**AWS Certified DevOps Engineer - Professional**: Amazon Web Services, 2019

**AWS Certified Security - Specialty**: Amazon Web Services, 2018

**AWS Certified Developer - Associate**: Amazon Web Services, 2018

**AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner**: Amazon Web Services, 2018

**AWS Certified SysOps Administrator - Associate**: Amazon Web Services, 2018

**AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Professional**: Amazon Web Services, 2018

**AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate**: Amazon Web Services, 2017

## Involvement

**Amazon Web Services (AWS)** **Remote**
*Subject Matter Expert (SME), AWS Certification Programs* *2019 – Present*

- Collaborated with AWS Training and Certification teams in 10+ workshops, shaping curriculum and examination standards.
- Contributed to the Job Task Analysis (JTA) for AWS Solutions Architect – Professional, helping design its structure.

## Skills

**Technical**: Terraform, Cloud Engineering, Splunk, Java, Python, Go, Qlik CDC, Amazon MSK, Airflow, Hadoop, AWS S3, EMR

**Business**: Data Management, Automation, Cost Optimization, AWS